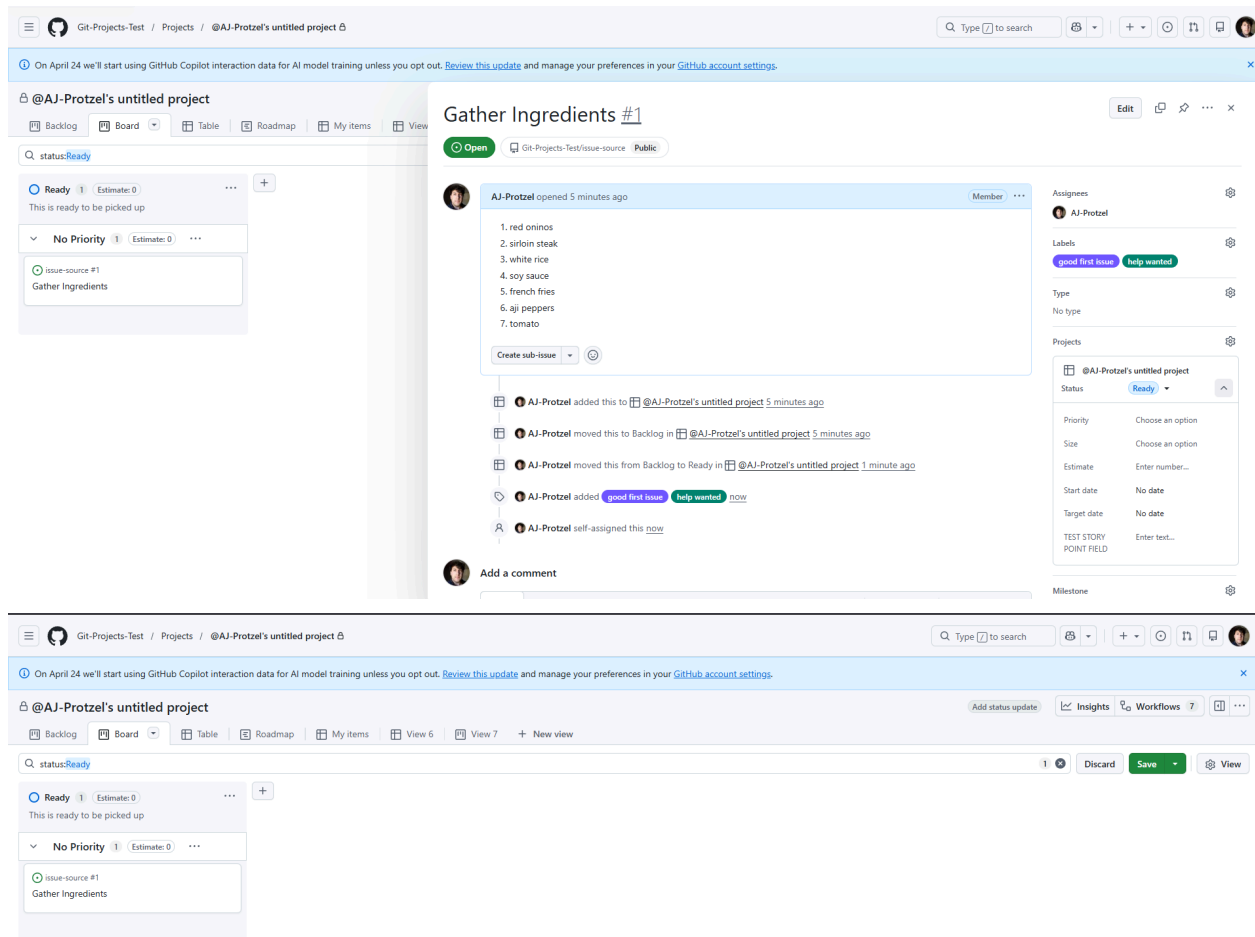


4.3 Exercise: GitHub First Look



1. Useful Features

The feature I think will be most valuable for our team during the Team Lab is GitHub Projects' direct integration with repositories, code, and organization members. Being able to link issues straight to commits, pull requests, and specific users within the organization means our project management and development work live in the same place. There's no need to context-switch between tools or manually sync progress updates.

2. Surprises or Friction

The biggest source of friction for me was the learning curve. Since this was my first time using GitHub Projects, I found the interface somewhat overwhelming. I didn't intuitively know where everything was or how to best manipulate the views and fields. I also noticed that in the Board view, some of the task and field information felt a bit buried or not immediately obvious. I'm sure this smooths out with experience, but coming in cold it wasn't the most beginner-friendly experience.

3. Jira vs. GitHub

Having explored both tools, I currently prefer Jira slightly, mostly because it felt more approachable with no prior knowledge. The interface guided me more naturally through setup and issue management. That said, I recognize that preference is largely a product of familiarity. If I invested more time in GitHub Projects, I think I would actually prefer it in a development context because of how tightly it integrates with the repository itself. Having issues, code, and collaboration all in one ecosystem is a compelling advantage that Jira can't fully replicate.